

ShopTrack

Owner Manual

Complete reference for running your business with ShopTrack

ShopTrack v2.7 — shoptrack.org

Chapter 1 — Platform overview

ShopTrack is a complete business management platform that runs in any modern browser on your phone, tablet, or computer. Nothing to install. Works offline — your data syncs automatically when you reconnect. One account gives you every feature in the platform.

Core modules

Module	What it does
Dashboard	Live overview of revenue, profit, AR, stock alerts, P&L, upcoming appointments
Sales	Record sales, issue receipts and invoices, track payments and outstanding balances
Inventory	Manage products, prices, photos, stock levels, "Made from" composition, and preferred vendors
Production	Log production batches that turn raw materials into bulk batches or finished products (UPDATED in v2.7)
Purchases	Record supplier orders, auto-increment stock, attach receipts
Rentals	Rental check-out/in, calendar, late fees, agreements, and overdue alerts
Customers	Full CRM with purchase history, balances, loyalty tiers, and WhatsApp reminders
Vendors	Supplier directory with contact info, payment terms, and AP balances
Appointments	Online bookings, staff scheduling, reminders, calendar management, photos, .ics export
Services	Catalogue of bookable services with prices, durations, and booking-page visibility
Expenses	Record and categorise all business expenses separated from personal spending
Documents	Invoices, receipts, rental agreements, quotes, project packs
Reports	P&L, sales, inventory valuation, AR aging, expense, and rental reports
Accounting	AR (customers owe you) and AP (you owe vendors) management
AI Studio	Generate product descriptions, marketing captions, and promotional flyers
WhatsApp	Automated alerts for sales, rentals, bookings, and payment reminders
Settings	Business profile, users, roles, currency, notifications, integrations

What's new in v2.7

Five major additions since the previous manual:

- **Production & recipe-driven sales** — Industry-agnostic 3-type inventory taxonomy (Raw Material / Bulk / Finished Product) replaces the old food-specific terms. The "Made from" panel (formerly called Recipe) lets any product list what it consumes. Selling a recipe-bearing product now auto-consumes its components — sell a scoop, the bulk decrements automatically.
- **One-tap Reorder** —  button on every inventory row, low-stock alert, and item detail. Opens a Purchase pre-filled with the item, preferred vendor, and last-known cost.
- **Preferred Vendor** — Optional field on every inventory item. Auto-fills the vendor when added to a Purchase. Powers the Reorder shortcut.
- **Appointment photos** — Up to 6 photos per appointment with captions. Auto-flow into Project Pack PDFs.
- **Add to Calendar** — Every confirmed appointment exports a .ics file that imports into Google, Apple, or Outlook calendars with a 15-minute reminder.

Chapter 2 — Dashboard

The Dashboard is the first screen you see when you log in. It shows your most important business metrics in real time, with a period filter that updates everything on the page including the P&L Summary card.

KPI cards

- Revenue — total sales amount for your selected period
- Gross Profit — revenue minus cost of goods sold
- AR Outstanding — total amount owed to you by customers
- Overdue Rentals — number of rental items past their due date
- Low Stock — count of inventory items below their minimum threshold

Period filter (top of dashboard):

- Today / Yesterday / This Week / Last Week
- This Month / Last Month / This Year / Last Year
- All Time / Custom date range

Other dashboard cards

- Quick Actions — one-tap buttons for the most common workflows
- Recent Sales — last 6 sales with status and amount
- Upcoming Appointments — next bookings on your calendar
- Top Products — best sellers in the selected period
- P&L Summary — full Revenue → COGS → Gross Profit → Overhead → Net Profit breakdown with gross margin and net margin percentages, all responsive to the period filter

Customise your dashboard

The  icon at the top right of the dashboard lets you reorder cards, hide ones you don't use, and choose your default period. Settings are saved per device.

Chapter 3 — Sales, invoices, and quotes

Sales is the heart of ShopTrack. Every transaction passes through here — whether you record it on a phone at the counter, generate an invoice from a desktop, or convert an accepted quote.

Recording a sale

- + New Sale → pick or create the customer (name + phone is enough)
- Add line items from inventory or create them on the spot
- Pick payment method (Cash, Mobile Money, Bank Transfer, etc.)
- Save → WhatsApp opens with the receipt pre-filled, ready to send

Invoices

For non-immediate-cash sales. Invoices generate a numbered, branded PDF with your logo, address, payment terms, and bank/mobile-money details (from Settings → Documents).

- Status flow: Draft → Sent → Paid (or Partial, Overdue)
- Unit-of-measure column on each line: "per hour", "per m²", "per piece", custom
- Auto-includes tax if a tax rate is set in Documents settings
- WhatsApp the invoice PDF directly from the invoice screen

Quotes

A pre-sale proposal that converts to an invoice when accepted. Same layout as invoices but with a validity date and a deposit-due block.

- Build line by line from your Services or Inventory
- Status flow: Draft → Sent → Accepted → converts to invoice
- The Quote PDF is invoice-grade — clients see professional output, not a basic listing

Chapter 4 — Inventory

Inventory is your central catalogue of everything you sell or use. Each item carries: name, category, brand, color, size, photo(s), sale price, cost, current stock, minimum threshold, preferred vendor, and (for manufactured products) a recipe.

Item fields that matter

- Sale price + cost — drives the gross margin calculation on every sale
- Minimum stock threshold — when stock falls below, the dashboard's Low Stock alert fires
- Photos — up to 3 per item, shown on the booking page, on receipts, and in catalogue PDFs

- Categories, sizes, colors — for filtering and searching as your catalogue grows

Preferred Vendor

Optional field that links each inventory item to one supplier you usually buy it from.

What it does

When you add this item to a new Purchase, the Purchase's vendor field auto-fills with the preferred vendor (only if no vendor is selected yet — never overrides your choice). Powers the one-tap  Reorder button. Skip it if you buy the same item from different vendors regularly.

One-tap Reorder

The  Reorder button appears in three places:

- Every row in the Inventory list
- Every row in the dashboard's Low Stock Alert
- The item detail modal footer

Low Stock Alerts

When an inventory item drops below its minimum stock threshold, it appears on the dashboard's Low Stock card. Each alert row has the  Reorder button for one-tap reorder — vendor and unit cost pre-filled from history.

Chapter 5 — Production & recipe-driven sales

The Production module is for businesses that turn raw materials into finished products. It automates the deduction of components, increments the finished product's stock, and calculates true batch cost — so the cost basis on your finished products reflects what you actually paid. As of v2.7, recipes also fire on sales: selling a "Scoop" can automatically consume bulk ice cream, selling a plate can consume from a prepared batch.

Use this if you run: a restaurant or food vendor, a bakery, an ice cream shop, a soap or candle maker, a brewery, a furniture maker, a cosmetics producer, a tailor, a homemade-craft business, or any operation where you transform inputs into outputs you sell.

The three inventory types — industry-agnostic

Every inventory item has a type that controls how it behaves. The three types apply across every industry — food, furniture, cosmetics, manufacturing:

- **Raw Material** — A component or ingredient consumed in production. No sale price required. Examples: leather, flour, oak boards, shea butter, screws, cement. Replenished via Purchase Orders.
- **Bulk / Batch** — An optional middle layer. A produced intermediate that gets portioned into finished products. No sale price required. Examples: 5L vanilla ice cream mix, an assembled chair frame before upholstery, 20L lotion mix before bottling, a 30-plate jollof batch. Skip this type if your business goes directly from raw materials to finished products.

- **Finished Product** — What customers buy. Requires a sale price. Examples: a pair of handmade shoes, a scoop of ice cream, a 100ml lotion bottle, a finished chair, a single plate of food.

The "Made from" relationship (formerly called Recipe)

On the Edit Inventory form, every item has a "Made from (consumes)" panel where you list what it's composed of. A Finished Product is typically made from Raw Materials (and optionally Bulk items). A Bulk item is typically made from Raw Materials. The relationship is one level deep.

Setup — choose your model first

Two valid models depending on your workflow:

- **Two-tier (Raw → Finished) — for homemade crafts and direct-build businesses** — Skip the Bulk layer entirely. Best for: a shoemaker assembling each pair from leather/sole/laces, a tailor sewing each dress from fabric/thread/buttons, a soap maker pouring one bar at a time. Setup: add each component as Raw Material; add the Finished Product with sale price; in its "Made from" panel, list the raw materials per unit. Selling one Finished Product consumes its raw materials. Producing a batch consumes the materials × the batch multiplier.
- **Three-tier (Raw → Bulk → Finished) — for portion-based businesses** — Use Bulk when you genuinely store an intermediate. Best for: an ice cream shop where 5L is mixed once and sold as 50 scoops, a restaurant pre-cooking a pot that yields 30 plates, a cosmetics lab where 20L is bottled into 200 × 100ml. Setup: add raw materials; add the Bulk item with its "Made from" panel listing materials; add each portion size as a separate Finished Product whose "Made from" lists the Bulk item × the portion ratio (e.g. Scoop is made from 0.1L of Vanilla Bulk).

Logging a production batch

Production page → "+ New Batch":

- Pick the product to produce (any item with a "Made from" list — Bulk or Finished)
- Set the batch multiplier (1× = one batch as the "Made from" defines; 3× = three batches)
- Watch the live preview — components table with Needed / On hand / Status columns, plus the produced qty + total batch cost
- Save → ShopTrack atomically deducts the components, increments the produced item, generates a batch ID (BATCH-0001), and records the consumed components with their unit-cost snapshot

Recipe-driven sales (selling without producing first)

When a Finished Product has a "Made from" list and you sell it directly (without a Production batch first), ShopTrack consumes the components in the same transaction. This unlocks the scoop/plate workflow: sell a Vanilla Scoop → automatically deducts 0.1L from Vanilla Bulk. Cost flows from the components automatically — even if the Finished Product itself has cost=0, COGS is computed by summing the recipe ingredients' costs.

Insufficient-stock guard

Production: if any component would go negative, the Save button is greyed out and a red callout lists each shortage with exact deficit. Sales: shortages don't block the sale (the customer is already paying) but a toast warns about insufficient stock so you can investigate.

Worked example — ice cream shop (three-tier)

Setup: raw materials (Heavy cream 1500ml, Whole milk 800ml, Sugar 200g, Vanilla beans 2). Bulk SKU "Vanilla Mix 5L" with "Made from" listing those four. Finished SKU "Vanilla Scoop" priced at 1,000 Frs with "Made from": 0.1L Vanilla Mix. Workflow: Saturday morning, log a Vanilla Mix batch → deducts raw materials, adds 5L of mix. All day, sell scoops normally → each scoop automatically consumes 0.1L from the bulk. After 50 scoops the bulk is empty.

Worked example — homemade shoes (two-tier)

Setup: raw materials (Leather sheet, Rubber sole pair, Shoelace pair, Glue). Finished SKU "Leather Loafer" priced at retail with "Made from": 0.4 × Leather sheet, 1 × Sole pair, 1 × Lace pair, 15ml Glue. Two valid workflows: (A) Make each pair on demand — selling one pair automatically deducts the materials. (B) Batch-produce 10 pairs Saturday morning via Production, then sell from stock all week.

Deleting a batch

The  button on any batch asks for confirmation, then atomically restores the components to inventory AND removes the produced qty from the produced item. Useful for "we marked the batch but actually didn't make it." Audited.

Chapter 6 — Appointments & online booking

Appointments handles staff scheduling, customer-facing online booking, automatic WhatsApp confirmations and reminders, photo attachments, and calendar exports.

Services catalogue

- Each service has: name, duration, price model (Flat / Hourly / Per unit), color, optional photo, optional staff assignment
- Two independent toggles per service: Active (available on invoices/quotes) and Visible on booking page (customers can book it online)
- Service photos drive booking rates — services with photos book at significantly higher rates than ones without

Public booking page

Settings → Booking Page → toggle "Accept online bookings" ON.

- QR code — printable code for your counter, flyers, business cards
- Preview button — see exactly what customers see before going live
- Confirmation note — customize the message customers see after booking

Availability Manager

Appointments →  Availability Manager controls what the booking page allows clients to select. Three view modes: Day, Week, Month.

- Whole-day blocks — vacation, holidays, supplier-trip days. Day appears greyed out on public page
- Partial-day blocks — lunch breaks, focus mornings, regular weekly commitments. Slots appear dashed and struck-through, cannot be selected
- Project execution windows — once a project is confirmed, block the install days to prevent double-booking
- Quick block buttons — Full Day, Morning 8-12, Lunch 12-14, Afternoon 14-18, custom range

Photos on appointments

Every appointment can hold up to 6 photos with optional captions.

- Use cases: hair-stylist reference photos, interior-designer site visits, wedding planner venue shots, repair-tech before/after
- Open any appointment → Edit → scroll to  Photos section → "+ Add photo" → choose from gallery or take fresh on mobile
- Each photo auto-compresses to 80–180 KB. Captions are optional but help when you revisit the record months later

Project Pack integration

When you generate a Project Pack PDF for a client (AI Studio → Branded Documents → Project Pack), every appointment's photos flow into the document automatically. The client gets a polished record of every visit with its visual brief.

Add to Calendar (.ics export)

Every confirmed appointment has a  Add to Calendar button.

- Tap → small .ics file downloads → default calendar app opens with the event ready to add
- Works with: Google Calendar, Apple Calendar, Outlook, Thunderbird, Yahoo, ProtonMail
- Includes: title (Service — Customer name), date/time, address, customer phone, staff, amount, status, full notes, and a 15-minute reminder

Re-importing updates instead of duplicating

Each export uses a stable identifier per appointment. If you reschedule and re-export, the calendar app recognises it as an update to the existing entry instead of creating a duplicate. Cancelled appointments hide the button — there's nothing to export.

Chapter 7 — Customers (CRM)

Every customer record carries full purchase history, balance, communication history, and type tags. Records are auto-created from sales and bookings (matched by phone number) — no need to import lists.

Custom customer types

Settings → Customer Types lets you create labels beyond the defaults (Regular / VIP / New). Useful ones: Lead, Active Project, Past Client, Referral, Trade (architect or builder partner), B2B. The Type field is what powers your filters later — you can pull up all past clients for a follow-up campaign in one click.

Project Pack PDF

For multi-touchpoint customers (interior design, weddings, catering), AI Studio → Branded Documents → Project Pack generates a comprehensive PDF including:

- Every appointment for this client (with photos)
- Every quote and invoice
- Every supplier purchase tagged to the project (via the "project handle" in Notes)

Chapter 8 — Purchases & vendors

Vendors is your supplier directory. Purchases logs every supplier delivery that increments inventory and creates accounts-payable balances.

Vendor records

- Each vendor has: name, contact, WhatsApp, payment terms, address, AP balance
- AP balance auto-tracks based on Purchase status (Pending / Partial / Paid)
- Vendor profile shows order history and a Pay Vendor button for recording payments

Purchase workflow

- + New Purchase → pick vendor → add line items
- Line items can link to inventory (auto-fills cost and increments stock on receive) or be free-text
- Add freight, duties, taxes, other adjustments — they roll into the total
- Status flow: Pending (ordered) → Partial (some delivered) → Received (all in) → Paid. Stock increments on Received

Chapter 9 — Reports

Reports → choose what to analyse:

- P&L — Revenue, COGS, Gross Profit, Overhead, Net Profit by period
- Sales Report — by customer, by product, by category, by staff
- Inventory Valuation — current stock × cost (the money tied up in your inventory)
- AR Aging — who owes you, how old each invoice is (Current / 30 / 60 / 90+)
- Expense Report — categorised, with year-over-year comparison

Chapter 10 — Notifications & WhatsApp

ShopTrack uses WhatsApp as the primary customer communication channel — it's where your customers already are.

What gets sent automatically

When triggered, ShopTrack opens WhatsApp on your phone with a pre-written message — you tap Send. (Approved Twilio templates send directly without a tap; non-template messages use the WhatsApp web fallback.)

- Sale alerts — every transaction pings your phone instantly
- Appointment confirmations — sent to the customer the moment you confirm
- Booking notifications — incoming online bookings notify you instantly
- Payment reminders — one-tap chase for unpaid invoices, pre-written and ready to send

Chapter 11 — Settings & administration

Settings is split into tabs: Business Profile · Users & Roles · Security · Subscription · Documents · Categories · Customer Types · Notifications · Financial · Booking Page · Backup.

Users & Roles

Add staff with controlled access. Each user has a role: Business Owner, Manager, Accountant, Store Staff, View Only.

- Roles control what each user sees and can do — Store Staff can't see profit reports, Accountants can't edit users, etc.
- Remove a user when they leave: status flips to Inactive, login is blocked at the next attempt with a clear message
- Removed users hide from the active list by default — expand "Show inactive users" to see them with Restore and Permanent Delete actions

About removed users

Removing a user soft-deletes them — login is blocked immediately, but the audit trail is preserved (every action they took is still attributed to them). You can Restore them if it was a mistake, or Permanently Delete them after Remove. The two-step delete prevents accidental hard-delete from a mis-click.

Currency & pricing

Settings → Financial sets your business currency. ShopTrack handles 9 currencies natively (USD, GBP, EUR, GHS, NGN, XAF, KES, UGX, ZAR) with correct decimal precision per currency (XAF and NGN show whole numbers; USD/GBP/EUR/GHS show 2 decimals). All amounts in inputs, displays, and reports respect this.

Getting help

ShopTrack support is real humans, fast response.

- WhatsApp: +1 304 503 3113 — fastest channel
- Email: support@shoptrack.work
- In-app: Settings → Documents has the Quick Start Guide and Owner Manual you're reading right now

— *End of Owner Manual* —